



COMMONLY KNOWN TO WESTERNERS AS SEA GYPSIES, the Bajau boat dwellers have lived scattered over the water off Philippines for thousands of years. Some live a nomadic life in outrigger houseboats and others settle in stilt houses at the water's edge. The Bajau people are famous for their pearl diving. Today, they retain rights to the pearl beds in the area, which are used by the modern pearl industry. Even these days, the Bajau divers free-dive to depths well beyond the safe limits of normal scuba diving. They can dive to depths of 125 ft (40 m).

